

Assignment Brief: Clinical Competency, Infection Control, and Field Operations in Aged Care

Course/Module: Clinical Competency

Assessment Weight: 100 Marks (100% of Assignment Grade)

Format: ShortEssay/Critical Responses

Expected Length: 300–450 words per question (3,000–4,500 words total)

Instructions to Students

This assignment requires you to critically evaluate contemporary frameworks in institutional care, ethics, law, and quality improvement. While these themes may have been introduced in course webinars, **every response must be grounded in independent external research.**

You must cite external literature, legal statutes, sociological concepts, or comparative international frameworks as specified in each prompt. Ensure all sources are correctly cited using the required academic referencing style (e.g., APA 7th Edition).

Question 1:

In clinical training, aged care is defined as a resident's home rather than a sterile hospital ward. How must a care worker balance the need for a warm, comfortable home environment with the strict clinical requirements of infection control and daily sanitation?

Question 2:

While face masks are standard, eye protection is frequently overlooked. Explain the clinical reason why eye protection is critical during close-contact care, specifically focusing on how droplets landing on the eye can enter the respiratory system.

Question 3:

During infectious outbreaks, facilities often implement strict isolation protocols to contain spread. How does a care worker uphold a resident's "Dignity of Risk" and mental well-being while complying with necessary public health isolation mandates?

Question 4:

Under what specific clinical conditions or procedures (such as aerosol-generating procedures) must a care worker transition from using a standard surgical mask to a fit-tested N95 respirator?

Question 5:

Define "Antimicrobial Resistance" (AMR) in your own words. Why is a robust Antimicrobial Stewardship program essential in shared residential care settings, and what is a care worker's role in it?

Question 6:

What is the difference between standard daily Infection Prevention and Control (IPC) practices and the protocols activated during an official respiratory outbreak (such as those guided by national CDNA guidelines)?

Question 7:

If an older resident or their family is hesitant about receiving recommended vaccinations (such as booster shots), what communication strategies should a care worker use to address their concerns respectfully while promoting clinical safety?

Question 8:

When conducting a first-time home care visit in a client's private residence, what are five key environmental or hygiene hazards a field worker must assess to ensure a safe working and care environment?

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Question 9:

Why is an "observational audit" (such as watching a staff member wash their hands or don/doff PPE) considered a more reliable measure of clinical competency than a written multiple-choice test?

Question 10:

According to the Hierarchy of Controls framework, Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) is classified as the least effective control measure. Explain why PPE is at the bottom of the hierarchy, and identify a more effective control measure used in aged care operations.

Marking Scheme & Grading Rubric (100 Marks Total)

Each of the 10 questions is worth **10 marks**, assessed against the following criteria:

High Distinction	9 - 10	Exceptional synthesis of external research. Argument is highly critical, nuanced, and perfectly directly addresses all parts of the prompt. Flawless referencing.
Distinction	7.5 - 8.5	Strong integration of external concepts. Solid analysis with clear logical flow. Minor gaps in depth or minor formatting issues.
Credit	6 - 7	Adequate research, though relies on basic definitions. Analysis is present but lacks critical depth or systemic insight. Competent writing and referencing.
Pass	5 - 5.5	Barely addresses the prompt. Heavy reliance on course materials rather than independent external research. Descriptive rather than analytical.
Fail	0 - 4.5	Fails to answer the prompt. Missing external research entirely. Poorly structured, lacking citations, or demonstrating fundamental misunderstandings of the topic.